

- Recycle it (there are many places you can drop off your old electronics for recycling).
- Call a junk removal firm.
- Sell or trade it (have a yard sale or sell online).
- Take it to Goodwill.
- If nothing else, toss it.

You'll probably be surprised how much stress is relieved by parting with your junk. It can be hard to part with things that you've owned for a while, but frankly, any potential monetary sacrifice can be compensated for by having a clean, livable abode. When they say that you can't take it with you, they aren't kidding.

— **Andrea Karim**

Biggest Money-Saving Tip: Move Far Away from the Joneses

I have to admit that while many people in the U.S. talk about “keeping

up with the Joneses,” I spent the first 20 years of my life never knowing what that meant. My rural lifestyle kept me somewhat content with the things I had. I quickly learned, however, that being “well-off” has a lot to do with “location, location, location.”

My first abrupt introduction into material desire came when I moved to the city. Living there the first two years, I never really felt I needed more. My friends and I all had clean apartments, enough food to eat, and extra cash for the occasional concert or party. I bought CDs when I wanted to, kept a pager, and wouldn't hesitate to buy a sweater on clearance at the outlet mall. I felt like I was really living the life, and my friends in the restaurant business felt the same.

After landing a very nice job at an insurance-related company, I was slowly seeing the world in a new way. Sweaters became suits, my pager was traded up for a cell phone, and \$2 taco dinners at the dive down the street gave way to \$9 wings at the upscale brewery. Even my car (which I adored) was feeling the pressure of this faster, more expensive social circle. (I remember telling my new coworkers about my Dodge Charger. They ran outside to see it, envisioning some souped-up *Dukes of Hazzard* look-alike to be waiting there. Their